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Clouds of gas and dust that comprise the Trifid nebula (top right) and the Lagoon nebula, which are several thousand light-years away from Earth.

Stunning galaxies revealed in once-in-a-generation moment

A new cosmic era begins as Rubin Observatory maps millions of galaxies

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N R,
Senior Associate Editor

A powerful new observatory has opened its eyes to the universe, revealing its first awe-inspiring images that promise to reshape our cosmic understanding.

Perched atop Cerro Pachón in Chile, the Vera C. Rubin Observatory — home to the largest digital camera ever built — has begun capturing the southern sky with breathtaking clarity.

In images released yesterday, vast nebulae and galaxy clusters shine in unprecedented detail. A composite of 678 exposures, taken over just seven hours, shows the Trifid and Lagoon Nebulae, star-forming regions located thousands of light-years away, glowing in vivid pinks and reds.

“The image reveals these stellar nurseries within our Milky Way in unprecedented detail,” AFP reported, noting



A small section of NSF-DOE Vera C. Rubin Observatory's total view of the Virgo cluster.

that previously faint or invisible features are now clearly visible.

Another sweeping image features the Virgo Cluster, a dense grouping of galaxies millions of light-years away. A zoom-out video, nicknamed the “cosmic treasure chest,” starts with two galaxies and reveals approximately 10 million more — just 0.05 per cent of the estimated 20 bil-

lion galaxies the telescope will observe over the next decade, according to CNN.

Investment for future
“The Rubin Observatory is an investment in our future,” Michael Kratsios, director of the White House Office of Science and Technology Policy, told AFP. “It will lay down a cornerstone of knowledge today on which our children will proudly build tomorrow.”

The US-funded facility features an 8.4-meter Simonyi Survey Telescope, a revolutionary mirror system, and a 3,200-megapixel camera — the largest digital camera ever built.

“This is a once-in-a-generation moment for astronomy,” said Professor Catherine Heymans, Astronomer Royal for Scotland. “For decades we wanted to build this phenomenal facility,” she told BBC.

In just 10 hours of test observations, the Rubin team discovered 2,104 previously unknown asteroids, including seven near-Earth objects — all of which pose no threat. By comparison, all other observatories combined discover around 20,000 new asteroids per year — a pace Rubin may soon exceed.

Indian businesses top list of new firms at Dubai Chamber

A total of 4,543 new Indian companies joined in first quarter

DUBAI

A new analysis by Dubai Chamber of Commerce, one of the three chambers operating under the umbrella of Dubai Chambers, has revealed that Indian-owned businesses topped the list of non-Emirati companies joining the chamber in Q1 2025.

A total of 4,543 new members from India joined during the three-month period, representing year-over-year (YoY) growth of 4.4 per cent and underlining the vital economic role played by Indian companies as Dubai's largest foreign business community.

Pakistan followed in second place, with 2,154 new companies registering as members of the chamber during the first quarter of the year and 1,362 new Egyptian companies joined the chamber, placing the country third among the top nationalities of new member companies.

Sectoral rankings
In terms of the sectoral distribution of new member companies, the wholesale and retail trade sector ranked first, accounting for 36.2 per cent of new registrations. The real estate, renting, and business services sector came in second place, representing 35.4 per cent of the total. This was followed by the construction sector in third place at 16.7 per cent.

— WAM

Trump is ‘still interested’ in Iran diplomacy

US EMBASSY IN QATAR WARNS ITS CITIZENS TO ‘SHELTER IN PLACE’

DOHA

Donald Trump thinks Iranians should overthrow their government if it refuses to negotiate on its nuclear program, but the US president is “still interested” in diplomacy, the White House said yesterday.

“If the Iranian regime refuses to come to a peaceful diplomatic solution, which the president is still interested and engaging in, by the way, why shouldn't the Iranian people take away the power of this incredibly violent regime that has been suppressing them for decades?” Press Secretary Karoline Leavitt said on Fox News.

Meanwhile, the United States embassy in Qatar advised Americans there to “shelter in place” yesterday, with other Western embassies echoing the warning after Tehran threatened to retaliate for US strikes on its nuclear sites.

Iran mulls retaliation

Ali Akbar Velayati, an adviser to Iran's supreme leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, said bases used by US forces could be attacked in retaliation.

“Any country in the region or elsewhere that is used by American forces to strike Iran will be considered a legitimate target for our armed forces,” he said in a message carried by the

official IRNA news agency. Qatar, which lies 190 kilometres (120 miles) south of Iran across the Gulf, is home to the US's largest military base in the region, Al Udeid.

“Out of an abundance of caution we recommend American citizens shelter in place until further notice,” the US embassy said on its website. Britain and Canada later cited the US security alert in their own recommendations to nationals.

Following the US warning in Doha, Qatar's foreign ministry spokesman Majed Al Ansari said warnings by foreign embassies “do not necessarily reflect the existence of specific or credible threats”.

“We would like to reassure the public that the security situation in the state remains stable,” he wrote on X. “Qatar continues to exert intensive diplomatic efforts to de-escalate tensions in the region.”

On Sunday, the US State Department advised Americans worldwide to “exercise increased caution”.

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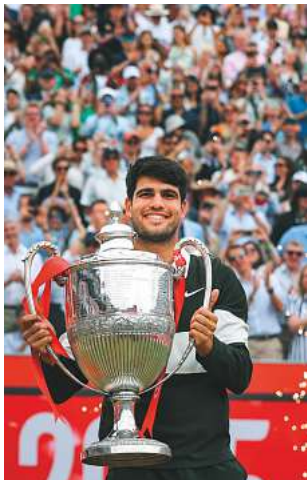
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